

Japan Healthcare: Pharmaceuticals: ASCO 2026: Focus on Ono/Takeda pipeline drugs, Daiichi Sankyo/Astellas competitors

We highlight the implications for our Japan pharmaceuticals coverage from the 2026 American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting. Clinical trial data was disclosed for (1) ONO-4578 from **Ono Pharmaceutical** and IBI363 (TAK-928), on which **Takeda** is partnering with Innovent, as well as for (2) competitor treatments to **Daiichi Sankyo**'s Datroway and **Astellas**' setidegrasib.

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While the results for ONO-4578 were generally positive, the subgroup analysis (we note this was an exploratory analysis with a small number of subjects) suggested that the patient group showing high efficacy could be limited. As such, we believe it could take time in order to build or ascertain further expectations for the drug. Regarding IBI363 (TAK-928) and sac-TMT, a potential competitor to Datroway, there is no major change to our view from the disclosure in the abstracts (released May 21 US time; see [this report](#) for our view). Favorable data were disclosed for daraxonrasib, a potential competitor to setidegrasib. While this does not change our view on setidegrasib at present, we think development trends for both drugs will need to be monitored closely.

Below we summarize news on pipeline drugs from companies in our Japan pharmaceuticals coverage, competitor products, and our views.

Ono Pharmaceutical (4528.T): ONO-4578 Phase 2 trial

Compared to the placebo combination group, the selective EP4 antagonist ONO-4578 showed a statistically significant extension of progression-free survival (PFS) when added to nivolumab (Opdivo) + chemotherapy combination therapy (the current standard of care), in a Phase 2 trial for first-line gastric cancer treatment (in Japan, South Korea, and Taiwan). The clinical benefit was more pronounced in the PD-L1 positive (CPS ≥ 1) group. On the other hand, there was no clear benefit in CPS < 1 or indeterminate patients ([link](#)), and a worsening trend was suggested in PFS, overall survival (OS), and overall response rate (ORR) in the ONO-4578 combination arm ([link](#), Japanese only). In addition, the improvement tended to be smaller in Claudin 18.2-positive patients ([link](#), Japanese only). Ono plans to initiate a global Phase 3 trial for gastric cancer this year.

Although we view this as generally positive progress, the subgroup analysis suggests that the patient population with high efficacy could be limited (note: this was an exploratory analysis with a small number of subjects). We believe it will be necessary to await additional data and Phase 3 trial results to build or ascertain further

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expectations for ONO-4578.

ONO-4578-08 trial (#4007, [Abstract](#), [Release](#))

- **Indication:** Chemotherapy-naïve, unresectable advanced or recurrent gastric cancer
- **Trial overview:** Combination of nivolumab and chemotherapy with either ONO-4578 (n=150) or placebo (n=76)
- **Efficacy:** Median PFS was 9.0 months in the ONO-4578 combination arm vs. 6.9 months in the placebo combination arm (P=0.040, hazard ratio [HR] of 0.67), median OS was not reached in the ONO-4578 combination arm vs. 12.7 months in the placebo combination arm (HR of 0.60), and ORR was 62.0% vs. 48.7%
 - In the **PD-L1 positive** (CPS ≥ 1) subgroup, median PFS was 9.9 months vs. 5.7 months (HR of 0.52), median OS was not reached vs. 12.7 months (HR of 0.44), and ORR was 70.9% vs. 50.9%
 - In the **PD-L1 negative** (CPS <1 or indeterminate) subgroup, no clear benefit was shown
- **Safety:** No new safety concerns were identified

Takeda Pharmaceutical (4502.T): Innovent announces IBI363 (TAK-928) Phase 1 trial results

Partner company Innovent Biologics announced results for IBI363 (TAK-928), which is expected to reactivate tumor-specific T-cells, in first-line (1L) non-small cell lung cancer (NSCLC) with PD-L1 low expression (TPS 1-49%) and PD-L1 negative (TPS <1%). Efficacy was confirmed regardless of subgroup, including (1) histological classification (non-squamous, squamous) and (2) PD-L1 expression level.

We do not interpret the results as prompting any major changes to our view held since the disclosure of the abstract ([link](#)), and we will also be focusing on the data announcement from the Phase 2 trial in the US ([NCT06281678](#)). For our China team's view, please see [the linked report](#).

TAK-928(IBM363)

Phase 1 dose optimization trial (#8586, [Abstract](#), [Release](#))

- **Indication:** 1L NSCLC
- **Trial overview:** Dose optimization trial of IBI363 (TAK-928) + platinum-based doublet-chemotherapy (PDC) (IBI363 3-1.5 mg/kg: n=23, 1.5 mg/kg: n=28, 3 mg/kg: n=29). Of all patients, 66.3% had squamous cell cancer. Also, 34.8% had PD-L1 low expression, and 65.2% were PD-L1 negative.
- **Efficacy: Confirmed ORR:** 81.8% in the 3-1.5 mg/kg arm (n=22; 3 mg/kg of IBI363 + PDC in the first cycle, followed by Q3W 1.5 mg/kg + PDC).
 - Within this arm, ORR was 78.6% in squamous NSCLC (n=14), 87.5% in non-squamous NSCLC (n=8), and 76.9% in PD-L1 negative (n=13) patients.
- **Safety:** The ratio of Grade 3 or higher adverse events related to IBI363 was 43.5% in the 3-1.5 mg/kg arm, 50.0% in the 1.5 mg/kg arm, and 69.0% in the 3 mg/kg arm.

- **Recommended dose:** Based on a comprehensive evaluation of the clinical trial results, the 3-1.5 mg/kg regimen is the recommended dose for 1L NSCLC.

Implications of sac-TMT Phase 3 trial results for Daiichi Sankyo (4568.T)

China trial data were announced for the pipeline drug sac-TMT (TROP2-targeting antibody-drug conjugate), a potential competitor to **Datroway (Dato-DXd)**, which we expect to be a medium- to long-term growth driver for Daiichi Sankyo, in the 1L NSCLC indication. For our China team's view on the OptiTROP-Lung05 trial results, please see [the linked report](#). For the global development of sac-TMT, we are watching the progress of the MRK-led TroFuse programs.

Although data for the competitor drug was favorable, we believe Datroway can be differentiated not only on efficacy but also on safety and convenience. Going forward, in 1L NSCLC, we will be watching for disclosure of results for (1) the AVANZAR trial, which targets TROP2 biomarker-positive patients (data expected in 2H2026), (2) the TROPION-Lung07 trial, which targets patients with a PD-L1 expression rate (TPS) of less than 50% (the corresponding TroFuse trial for sac-TMT has not been disclosed at this time), and (3) the TROPION-Lung08 trial, which targets patients with TPS of 50% or more (the TroFuse-07 trial for sac-TMT targets PD-L1 high patients).

sac-TMT (Kelun/MRK)

OptiTROP-Lung05 Trial (#8506, [Abstract](#), [Release](#))

- **Indication:** 1L NSCLC with PD-L1 TPS $\geq 1\%$
- **Trial overview:** Comparison of sac-TMT + pembrolizumab combination therapy (n=208) with pembrolizumab monotherapy (n=205)
- **Efficacy:** Median **PFS** was not reached vs. 5.7 months (HR of 0.35). **OS** showed a trend of improvement in the sac-TMT + pembrolizumab arm (HR of 0.55).
 - The HR for median PFS was 0.47 in PD-L1 high (TPS $\geq 50\%$) cases and 0.28 in PD-L1 low (TPS 1-49%) cases.
 - The HR for median PFS was 0.28 in non-squamous NSCLC and 0.44 in squamous NSCLC.
- **Safety:** The most common grade 3 or higher TEAEs of special interest for sac-TMT were neutrophil count decrease (17.3%), anemia (9.1%), and stomatitis (5.3%).

Implications of daraxonrasib Phase 3 trial results for Astellas (4503.T)

Revolution Medicines' (RVMD) daraxonrasib (RAS(ON) multiselective inhibitor) is a potential competitor to setidegrasib (a protein degrader targeting KRAS G12D), which Astellas is developing for pancreatic cancer (PDAC) and lung cancer (NSCLC). At ASCO 2026, results from the Phase 3 RASolute 302 trial of daraxonrasib in PDAC 2L+ were announced, showing favorable efficacy in PDAC, an area of high unmet need.

While our view on setidegrasib is unchanged at present, we think it will be necessary to closely monitor future development trends for both drugs, especially the clinical trial results in the 1L setting (Astellas is currently conducting a global Phase 3 trial in metastatic PDAC 1L with the KRAS G12D mutation ([NCT07409272](#))). RVMD is conducting

the RASolute303 trial of daraxonrasib for metastatic PDAC 1L, and the RASolute305 and RASolute309 trials of the G12D-targeting zoldonrasib for metastatic PDAC 1L).

daraxonrasib (RVMD)

Phase 3 RASolute 302 trial (LBA5, [Abstract](#), [Release](#))

- **Indication:** Previously treated metastatic pancreatic ductal adenocarcinoma (PDAC)
- **Trial overview:** Once-daily oral administration of daraxonrasib 300mg versus investigator's choice chemotherapy
- **Efficacy: OS (Overall survival):** Median OS was 13.2 months in the daraxonrasib arm and 6.7 months in the chemotherapy arm (HR of 0.40). The OS HR in KRAS G12D/V mutations was 0.38.
- **Safety:** TEAE rates leading to treatment discontinuation were 1.2% in the daraxonrasib arm and 11.2% in the chemotherapy arm.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Ono Pharmaceutical

We are Sell-rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥2,100 is based on a 12-year DCF model assuming WACC of 6% and terminal growth of 0%. Key upside risks include better-than-expected sales of key drugs, pipeline drug progress, changes in product evaluations, changes in expectations for Opdivo indication expansion/market share gains with the release of trial data, expansion of the pipeline through in-licensing, and progress on establishing the overseas business platform.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Takeda Pharmaceutical

We are Neutral rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥5,600 is based on a 12-year DCF model assuming WACC of 6% and terminal growth of 0%. Key risks include better-/worse-than-expected sales for key drugs, drug development suspension or delays and changes in product evaluation, impacts from the macro environment, including changes in US and other countries' drug pricing/medical systems, the emergence of finance risks related to large acquisitions and/or lower-than-expected sales/profits.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Daiichi Sankyo

Our 12-month target price of ¥4,300 is based on a 12-year DCF model assuming a WACC of 6% and terminal growth rate of 0%. We are Buy rated. Key risks include weaker-than-expected sales of key drugs, drug development suspension or delays, changes in product evaluation, negative news flow concerning the ADC franchise, and the impact of the macro environment, including changes in global drug prices and healthcare systems, particularly in the US.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Astellas Pharma

We are Buy rated on Astellas. Our 12-month target price of ¥2,950 is based on a 12-year DCF model, assuming a WACC of 6% and terminal growth of 0%. Key risks include worse-than-expected sales of key drugs, drug development suspension or delays, changes in product evaluation, negative news regarding medium-term growth drivers Padcev and Vyloy, and macro impacts, including changes in drug prices and healthcare systems globally, particularly in the US.

Disclosure Appendix

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DAFCF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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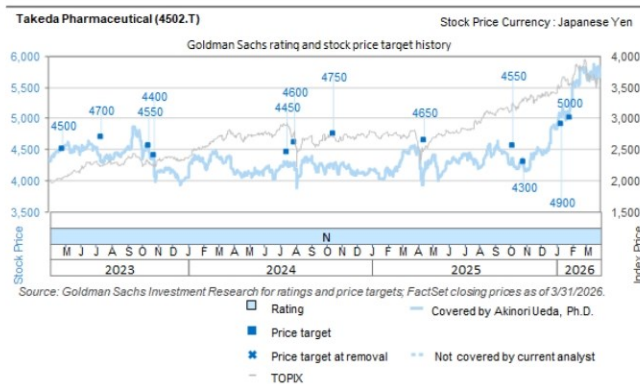
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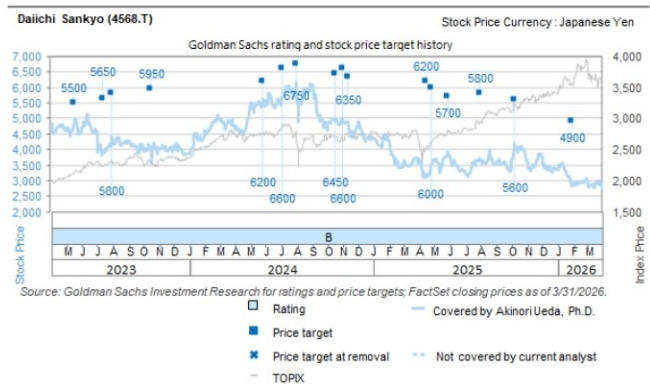
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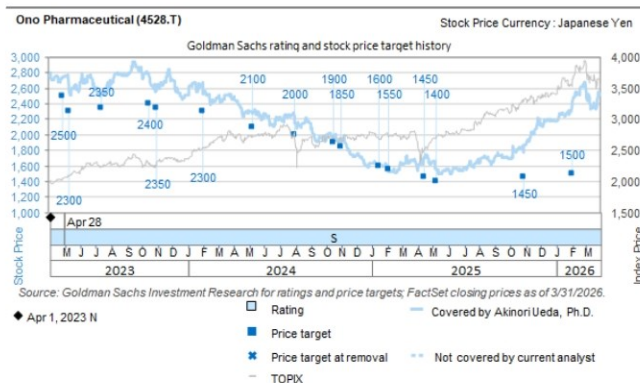
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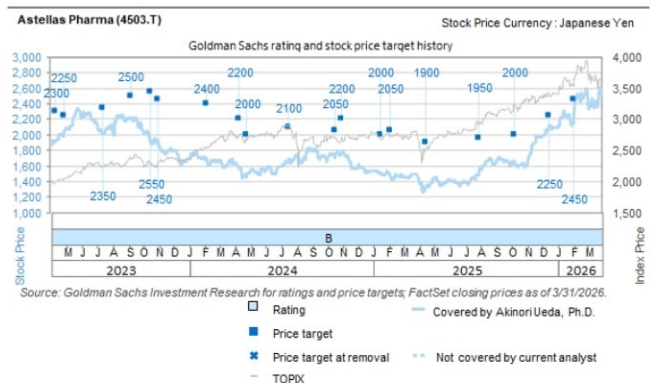
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Target price history table(s)

Takeda Pharmaceutical (4502.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
13-May-26	5,600	5,192
14-Apr-26	5,500	5,604
29-Jan-26	5,000	5,153
13-Jan-26	4,900	5,020
30-Oct-25	4,300	4,257
09-Oct-25	4,550	4,336
15-Apr-25	4,650	4,160
16-Oct-24	4,750	4,193

Ono Pharmaceutical (4528.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-May-26	2,100	2,481
14-Apr-26	1,900	2,477
02-Feb-26	1,500	2,382
30-Oct-25	1,450	1,877
08-May-25	1,400	1,569
15-Apr-25	1,450	1,720
03-Feb-25	1,550	1,532
15-Jan-25	1,600	1,630

Takeda Pharmaceutical (4502.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-24	4,600	4,302
17-Jul-24	4,450	4,309
26-Oct-23	4,400	4,347
17-Oct-23	4,550	4,474
13-Jul-23	4,700	4,326

Ono Pharmaceutical (4528.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Oct-24	1,850	1,913
16-Oct-24	1,900	1,961
31-Jul-24	2,000	2,238
09-May-24	2,100	2,274
31-Jan-24	2,300	2,672
01-Nov-23	2,350	2,561
17-Oct-23	2,400	2,758
13-Jul-23	2,350	2,553

Daiichi Sankyo (4568.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
14-Apr-26	4,300	2,734
30-Jan-26	4,900	2,836
09-Oct-25	5,600	4,174
31-Jul-25	5,800	3,720
29-May-25	5,700	3,894
25-Apr-25	6,000	3,523
15-Apr-25	6,200	3,216
12-Nov-24	6,350	4,850
31-Oct-24	6,600	4,981
16-Oct-24	6,450	4,926
31-Jul-24	6,750	6,148
04-Jul-24	6,600	5,677
27-May-24	6,200	5,627
17-Oct-23	5,950	4,035
31-Jul-23	5,800	4,347
13-Jul-23	5,650	3,986

Astellas Pharma (4503.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
27-Apr-26	2,950	2,386
14-Apr-26	2,800	2,521
04-Feb-26	2,450	2,248
16-Dec-25	2,250	2,126
09-Oct-25	2,000	1,663
30-Jul-25	1,950	1,488
15-Apr-25	1,900	1,337
04-Feb-25	2,050	1,485
15-Jan-25	2,000	1,529
30-Oct-24	2,200	1,789
16-Oct-24	2,050	1,711
17-Jul-24	2,100	1,688
25-Apr-24	2,000	1,455
10-Apr-24	2,200	1,574
05-Feb-24	2,400	1,700
01-Nov-23	2,450	1,944
17-Oct-23	2,550	1,926
07-Sep-23	2,500	2,208
13-Jul-23	2,350	2,009

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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